



Setting the Momentum to Achieve High Goals in Work & Life

A member of the Indian Railway Services, Ms. Seema Kumar, is CMD of the Mini Ratna PSU- Indian Railway Catering and Tourism Corporation Ltd. (IRCTC), headquartered in New Delhi. A successful career as a civil servant that is, Indian Railway Traffic Services officer posted as additional member of the Railway Board, spanning more than 35 years has enriched her experience, both as a professional and person. She is adeptly steering IRCTC through a vision aimed at innovation, impeccable services and lastly CSR, that gives vent to her passion to serve the community in areas such as food, shelter, and education. Ensuring equitable growth opportunities for women is another mission close to her heart and under her leadership, IRCTC has grown 40% in the last six months in terms of its share price and market capitalisation.



■ Ms. Seema Kumar

CMD Mini Ratna PSU- Indian Railway Catering and Tourism Corporation Ltd. (IRCTC)

Academic Excellence

Seema Kumar is truly an epitome of women power with excellence writ large on her visage. She grew up in a stimulating ambience of academic excellence where her father served as a professor and Head of the Department of Mathematics of a Post Graduate college. She is a Gold Medallist in M.Sc. (Physics) from Meerut University, and an M. Tech. from IIT/Delhi. Leadership Program from SDA Bocconi Institute/ Milan, Italy and Leadership Management Executive Program from Indian Institute of Management/Bangalore are other trainings adding to the vast experience of Seema Kumar. Backed by such qualifications, her career was slated to be as

exciting.

Railway Career

Seema Kumar has held several senior positions in various departments of the Indian Railways, including Divisional Railway Manager, Kota, Rajasthan, charge of the posts of Additional Member (Traffic), Additional Member (Marketing & Business Development), Railway Board. She has also served as Chairperson of various Railway SPVS like KRCL, BDRCL & PRCL etc. She took additional charge as CMD of IRCTC on 1st June, 2023. She is known for her pivotal role in the design and development of Unreserved Ticketing System, design and conceptualization of Next Generation e-ticketing System and integration of the National Train Enquiry System Application. With her sound technical knowledge and leadership skills, she is credited with the launch of two new citizen-centric innovative schemes viz; Bharat Gaurav Tourist Trains (BGT) and One Station One Product (OSOP).

Her achievements and contributions to the Railways were recognised with various awards like Platinum Award for Web-based Citizen Services in the year 2009, Silver Award for e-Governance 2010-2011 under the category 'Innovative Use of ICT by PSUs for Customer's Benefits' and National Tourism Award 2014-2015 for showcasing Cultural Heritage and Local Talent.

Inclusive approach

Seema actively promotes an inclusive work environment for all, irrespective. The strategies involved include training, up-skilling, creating opportunities for growth and build a learning environment to keep pace with the dynamic developments taking place in the Railway sector. Additionally, she cautions that to keep the bar

of excellence high it is important to consistently monitor the talent process for a fair deal. She says, "There must be ongoing analysis as to who is represented in leadership, who we are promoting, and why, something that organizations must be aware of and keep working on. To help create an ideal state, we need a feedback mechanism that regularly examines company policies and provides employees with a safe space to discuss issues."

Mentor to Women

A woman achiever, Seema Kumar, rose to positions of power on the dint of her hardwork, merit and strong values. She believes that the contribution of women towards the family and society should not be undermined, rather, they should be acknowledged, honoured and celebrated worldwide. Saluting the strength and determination of women, which is indispensable for socio-economic growth, Seema, strongly advocates that an equitable workplace, pay parity and secure society for women is her birthright. Seema says, "Believe in yourself as the foundation of your professional evolution, and success is bound to follow. So unfetter yourself from limitations, use whatever resources you have to move forward. Build healthy networks and seek a mentor for yourself, which would be the magic key to unlock your incredible potential to become successful. But as you move higher lean out a hand for those below you to rise in life and prosper." This she believes can be achieved by creating opportunities for education, learning, and vocational training for those women, as many come under unorganised labour. Also, there is need to set right pay disparity and focus development around gender and diversity.

Not one to rest on her laurels, Seema Kumar, is set for the next venture, the next conquest!